

Pass it on: letting a respondent send the Verto to friends and family

What the end of a Verto offers, what the friend receives in WhatsApp, Messages and the feeds, the social image behind the link, and where the creator writes the narrative headline. A change.org-style share: a headline that tells the story, a picture, and a message in the respondent's own voice.

- Fictional example: Haverley Town Council
- Player at 390×844 and 1280×800
- Share image at 1200×630
- Spec for the implementer at the foot

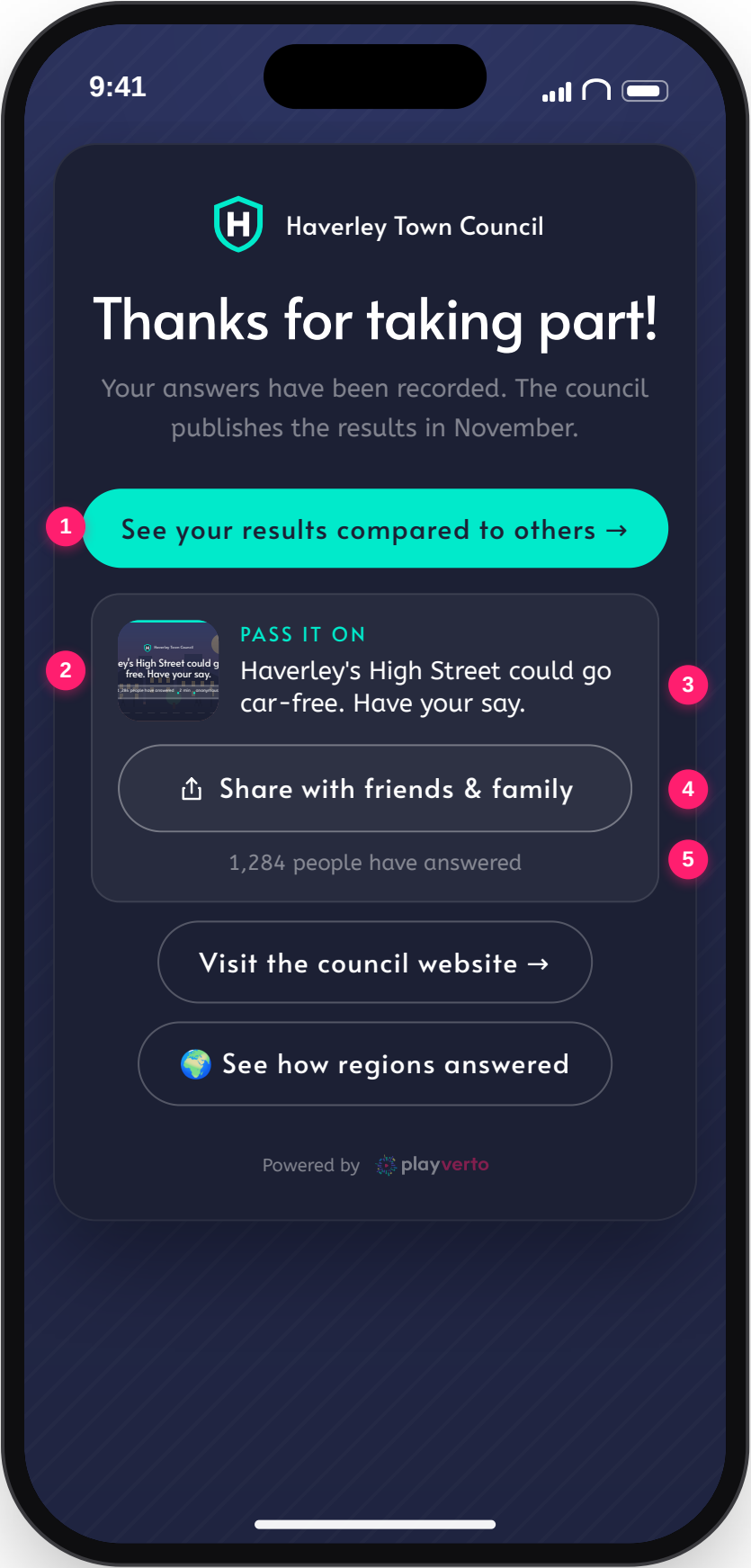
AI End screen, mobile A2 Share sheet A3 iOS share sheet BI End screen, desktop B2 Share modal C The link unfurled DI The share image D2 Crops & variants E Editor F Dashboard tile § Spec

The worked example

Today the link unfurls as *"Car-free High Street · Playverto"* with the creator's editing brief underneath and no picture. The mockups give the Verto three creator-written share fields and one generated image, and turn the end-screen Share button into a moment. Every board below uses this copy:

Verto <code>theme</code> (today's og:title)	Car-free High Street
<code>share_title</code> – the narrative headline	Haverley's High Street could go car-free. Have your say. 56 / 70
<code>share_description</code>	Haverley Town Council is deciding whether to close the High Street to through-traffic at weekends from spring 2027. Two minutes, anonymous – and you'll see how your neighbours answered. 186 / 200
<code>share_message</code> – in the respondent's voice	I just had my say on whether Haverley High Street should go car-free – it took two minutes. Add yours before the council decides on 14 October: 143 / 160 · link appended by the app
Default when the creator leaves it blank	I just answered this – it takes two minutes. Will you add your voice?
"Include my answer" variant (opt-in)	I answered "Yes – close it at weekends". 62% of 1,284 people agree with me so far – where do you stand?
Share URL	<code>https://app.playverto.com/play/haverley-high-street?via=r</code>

THANK-YOU SCREEN WITH THE SHARE CARD

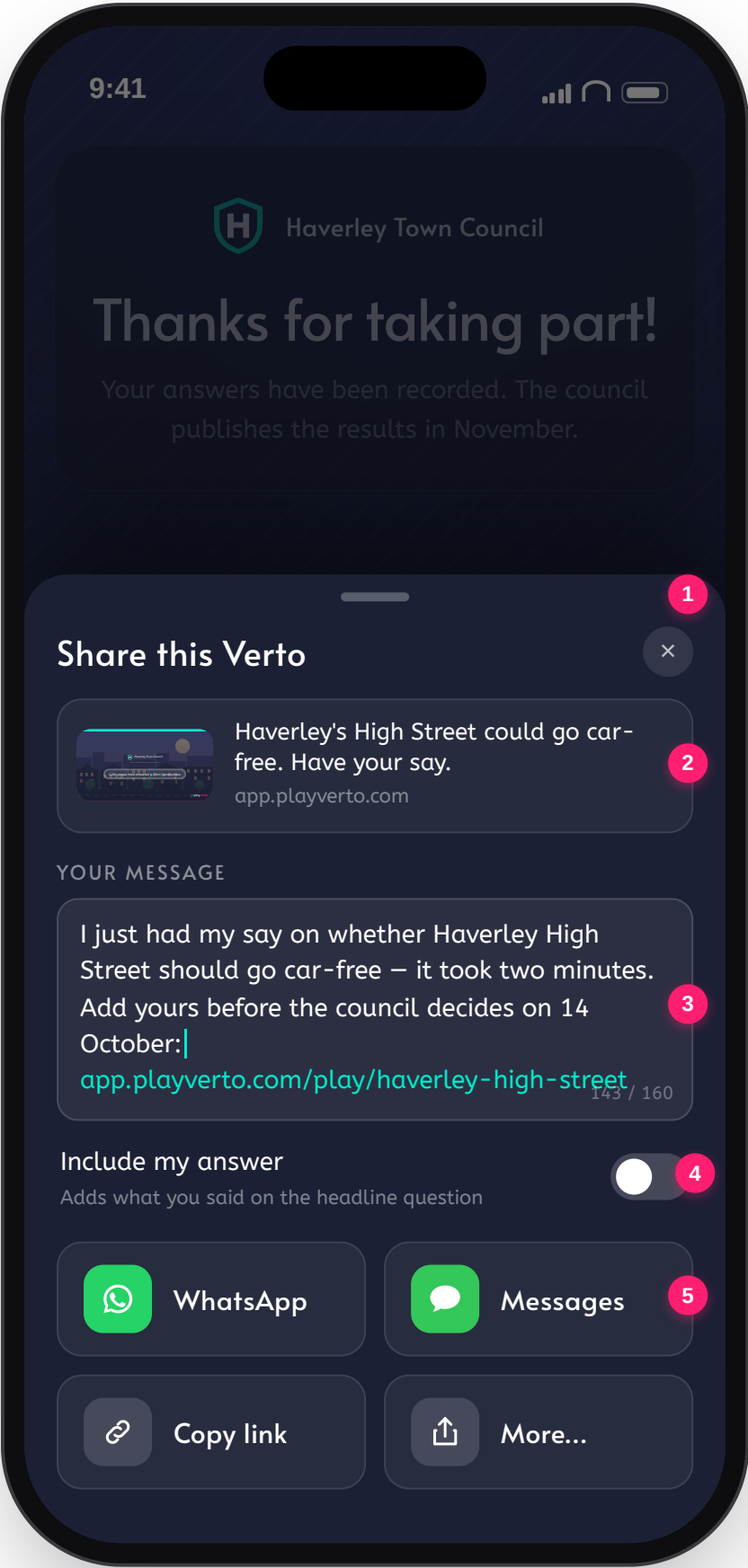


NOTES

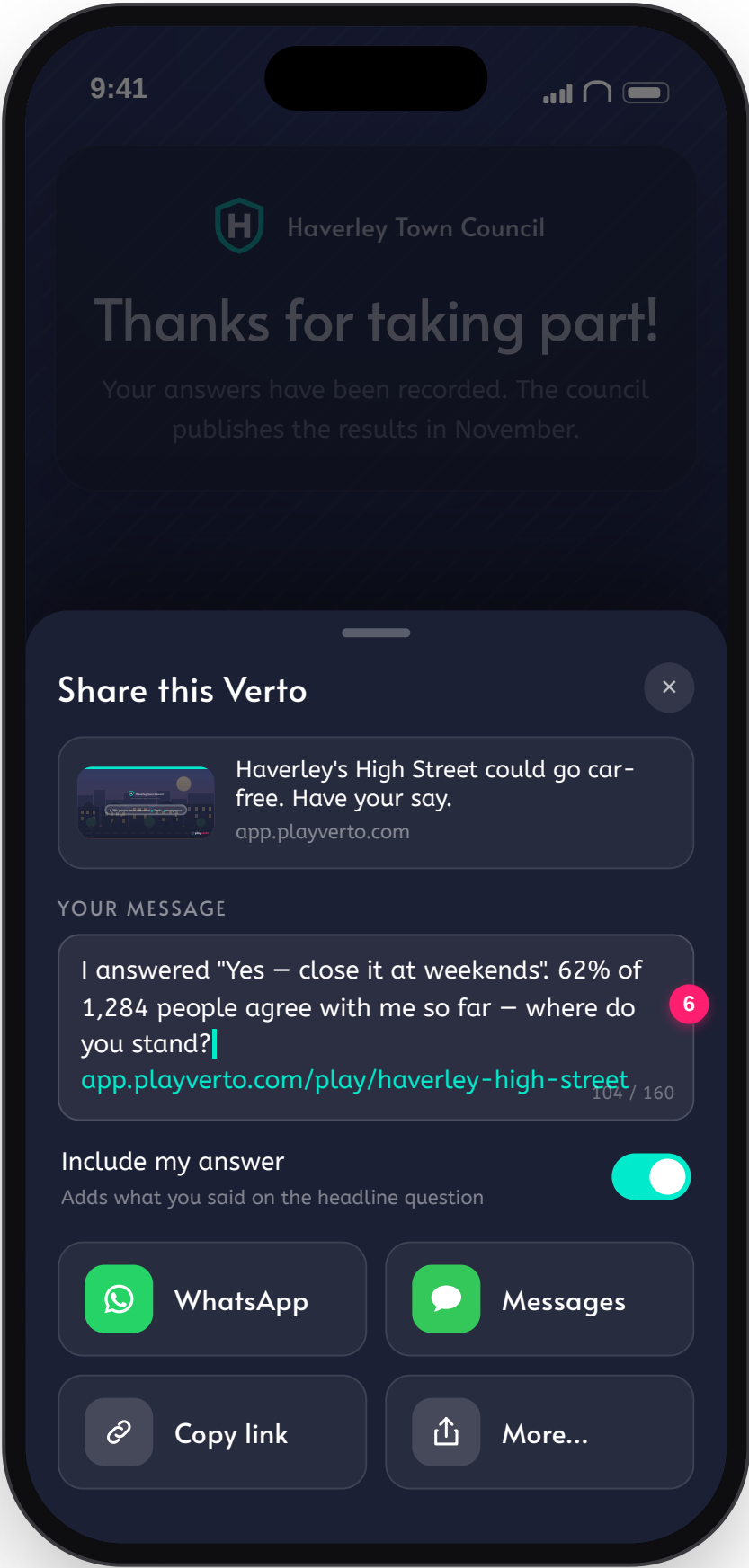
- 1 The reward stays first. "See your results compared to others" remains the primary CTA; the ask to share comes directly under it, where the respondent's attention is still on the Verto.
- 2 The bare outline *Share* button (`show.html.erb:433`) becomes a card. Its 56px thumbnail is the real share image – the same picture friends will see – which is what turns a button into a moment. §3
- 3 The narrative headline, not the internal title. Creator-written in the editor (board E); falls back to today's "theme · Playverto" when blank, so nothing regresses. §1
- 4 One CTA in the respondent's own terms. Tapping opens the in-page sheet (A2), never the OS sheet directly. §6
- 5 The count comes from the tally the compare panel already fetches; it is hidden under 50 responses so a young Verto never says "12 people".

Everything else on the screen is unchanged. The card costs about 110px against the 44px button; the screen already scrolls (`application.css:6326`). Quiz and leaderboard Vertos slot the same card under their score board.

SHEET AS IT OPENS



WITH "INCLUDE MY ANSWER" ON

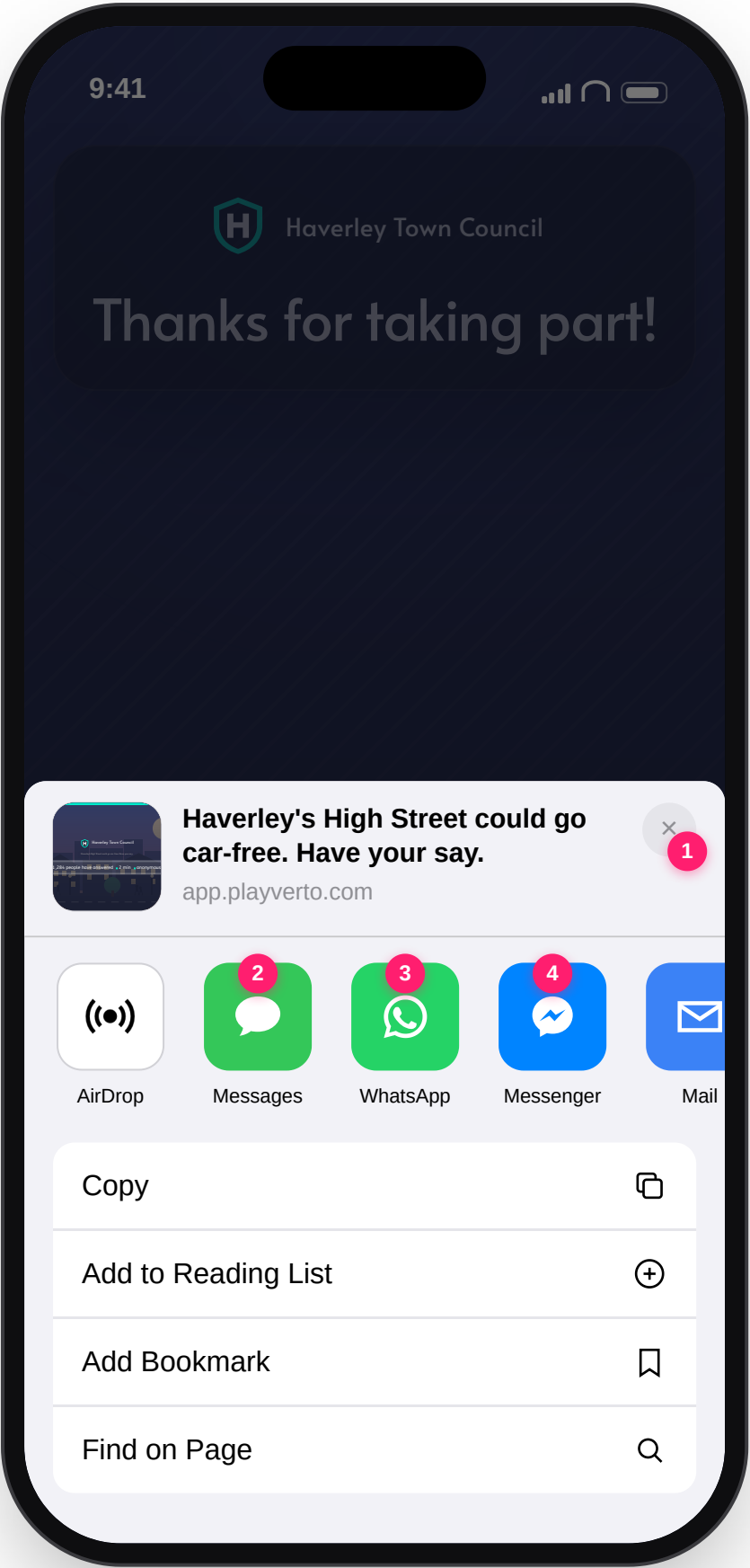


NOTES

- 1 A bottom sheet on the first tap, always. Instagram, Facebook and Messenger open links in a WebView that has no `navigator.share`, so a sheet that only appeared as a fallback would be the primary surface for a large slice of respondents anyway. `change.org` does the same.
- 2 The preview strip is what the friend will receive: picture, headline, host.
- 3 The message is editable and prefilled from `share_message` (creator-written, 160 cap). The link is appended by the app, never typed, so it can't be mangled. §1 §6
- 4 "Include my answer" is off by default and only rendered when the Verto's comparison is public – the tally is already visible there, so nothing new is exposed. §7
- 5 WhatsApp → `wa.me/?text=`; Messages → `sms:?&body=` (iOS) / `sms:?body=` (Android); Copy link → clipboard with the ✓ feedback the button has today; More... → `navigator.share({title, text, url})`, hidden where it doesn't exist. §6
- 6 With the toggle on, the message is rebuilt from the respondent's own answer on the headline card and the live tally. Still editable.

Email and the social networks live behind More... on a phone; on a laptop they come forward (B2).

WHAT NAVIGATOR.SHARE({TITLE, TEXT, URL}) OPENS



NOTES

- 1

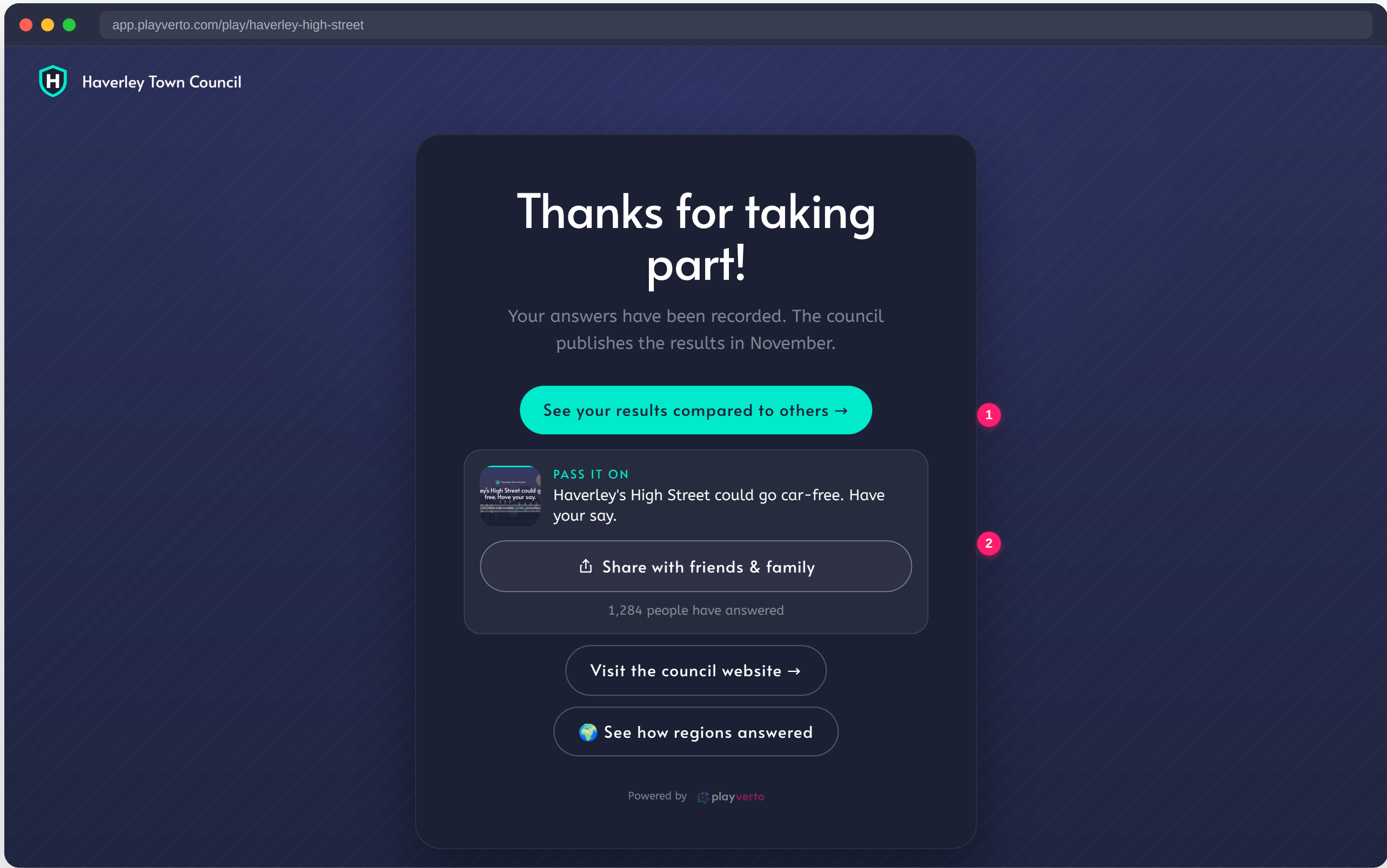
iOS builds this header from the URL's own metadata – the share image and og:title pay off inside the sheet, before anything is sent. It is fetched from the sender's device, so robots.txt does not come into it. [§2](#)
- 2

Messages sends the text as one bubble and the URL as a rich link card (see C3).
- 3

WhatsApp sends text ↵ URL as one message, with the preview beneath (C1).
- 4

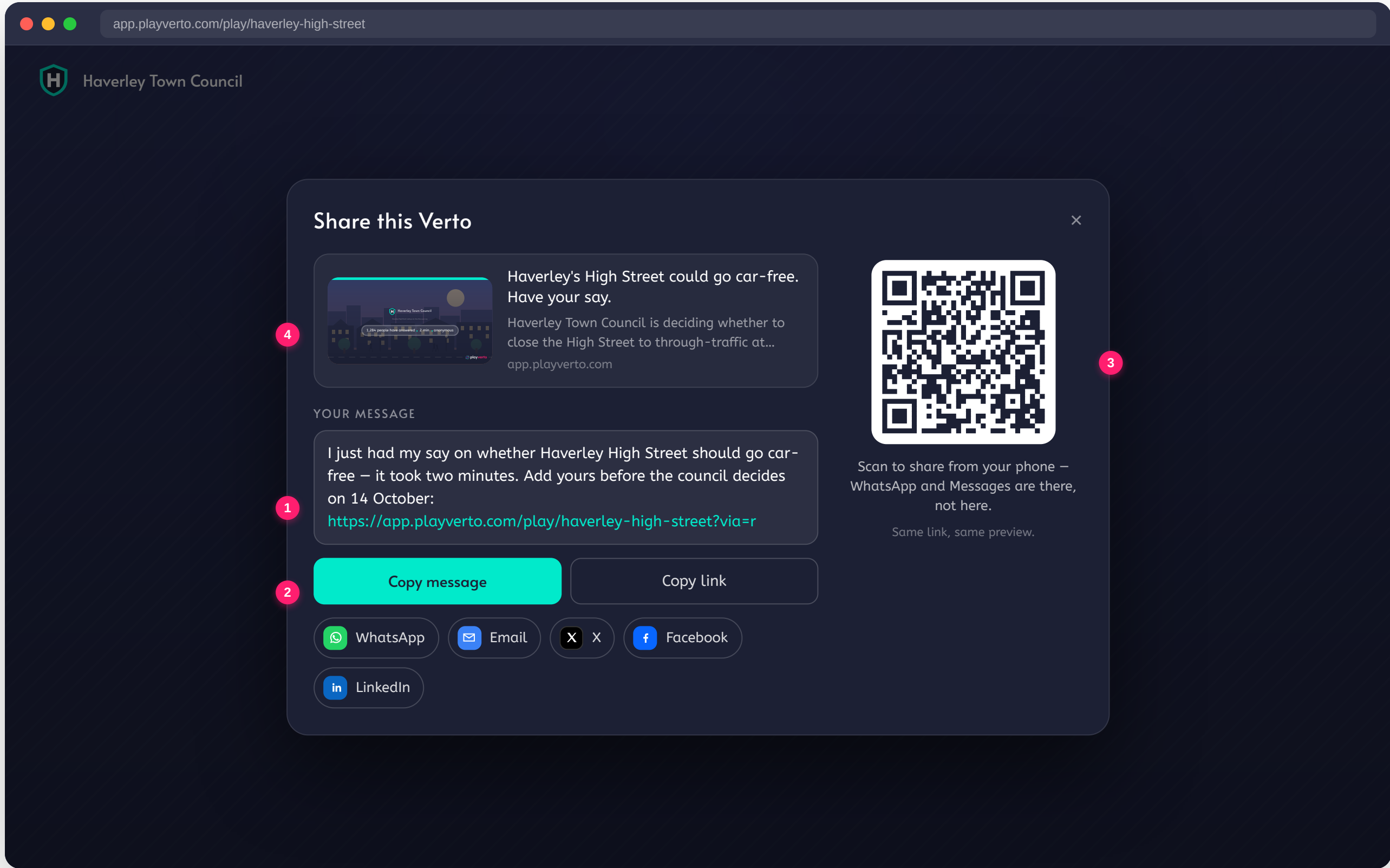
Messenger, Instagram, Snapchat take only the URL and drop the text – the narrative rides entirely on the OG tags. That is why the headline has to stand alone. [§2](#)

Never pass `files:` . An attached image suppresses the link preview and turns this into a photo-sharing sheet – Messages would send a photo plus a bare URL and the card disappears. A "Save image" for Instagram Stories is a later, separate control.



NOTES

- 1 The same card inside the 520px .preview-thankyou-card . The masthead already carries the org logo on desktop (show.html.erb:370), so the card doesn't repeat it.
- 2 Clicking opens the modal (B2) rather than a sheet – the same content, laid out for a mouse and a wider screen.



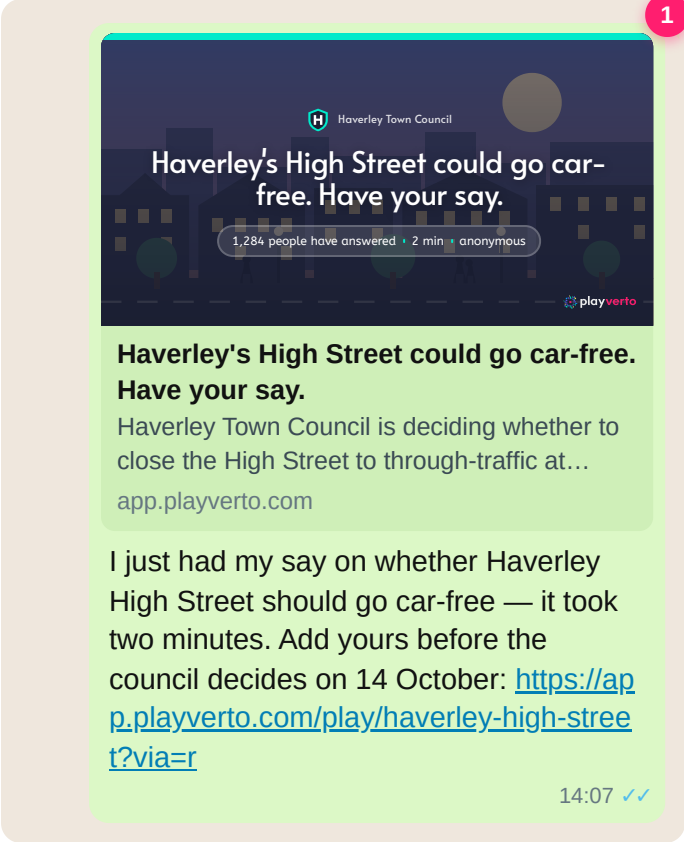
NOTES

- 1 **Copy message** is the primary. On a laptop the destinations are Messenger web, Slack, Teams and email; a bare URL loses the narrative wherever nothing unfurls.
- 2 WhatsApp opens WhatsApp Web via `wa.me` ; Email is `mailto:?subject=<headline>&body=<message + link>` ; X intent, Facebook sharer, LinkedIn share-offsite – the chip set the owner-side modal already has `( survey_links/show.html.erb:91 )`. §6
- 3 A QR of the share URL through the existing `verto_qr_svg` helper. The URL is per-Verto, so it renders straight into the cached page. §5
- 4 The preview shows the description too – Facebook, WhatsApp and Slack display it; iMessage, X and LinkedIn don't.

Messages is hidden here (no SMS handler on a laptop); More... appears only where `navigator.share` exists, which today means macOS Safari.

WHATSAPP (IOS) fetched on the sender's phone

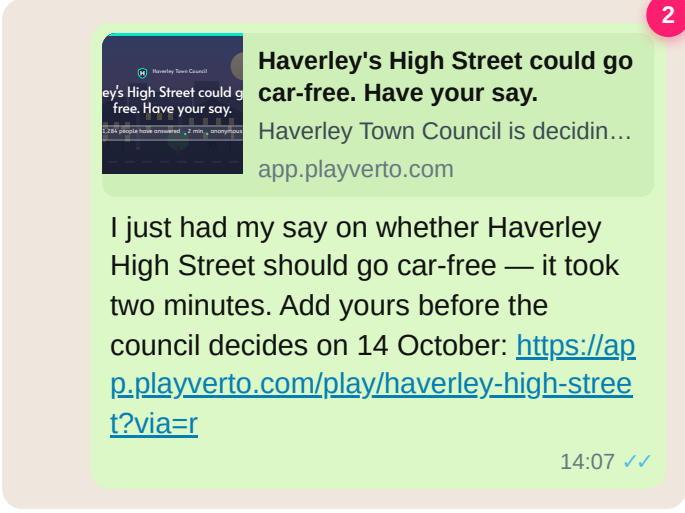
1



Large preview: og:image ≤ 300 KB, ≥ 300×200, JPEG. Title 2 lines, description 2 lines, then host. Text and Link travel in the same bubble.

WHATSAPP — FAILURE MODE image over budget

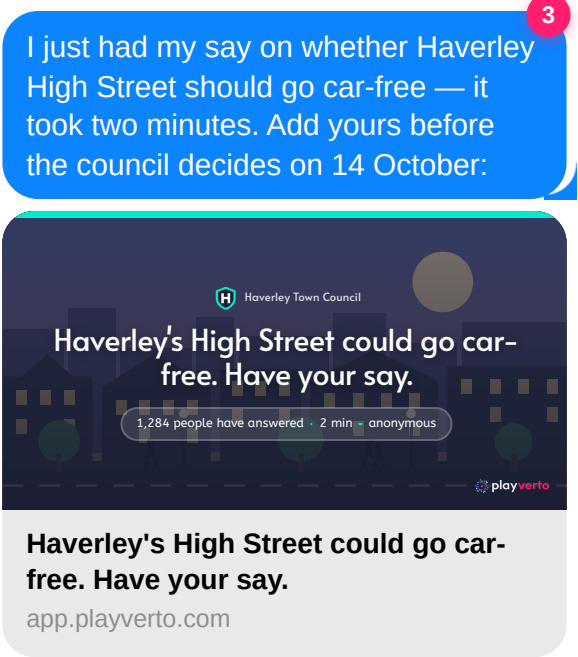
2



What the same link looks like if the image is over 300 KB or the fetch times out: a 70px centre-cropped square. Legible headline, invisible picture. This is what the size budget in §3 buys.

IMESSAGE fetched on the sender's phone

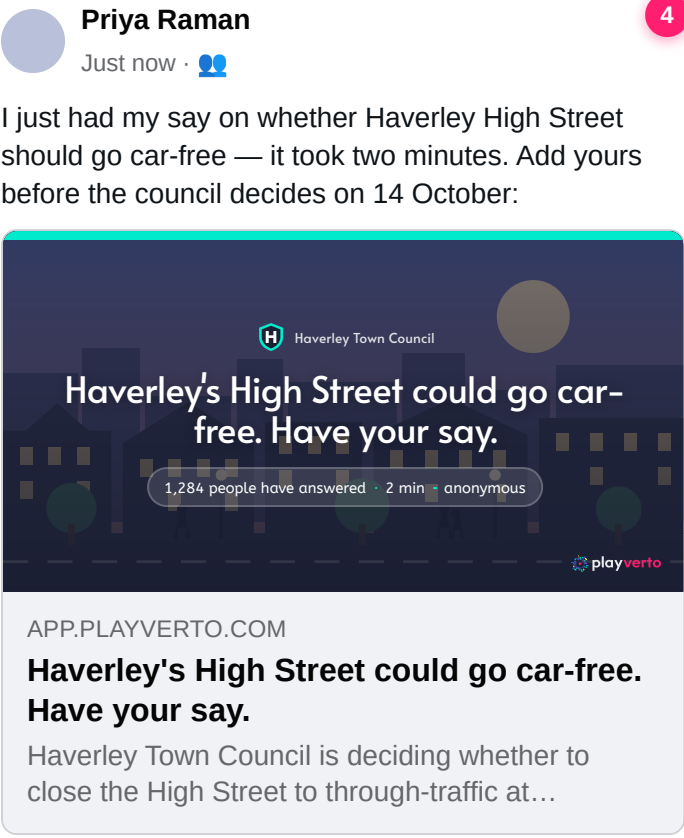
3



Text bubble, then a rich link card: image, og:title, host. og:description is never shown, so the headline must carry the story on its own. Needs an absolute https og:image.

FACEBOOK / MESSENGER crawlable — robots fix shipped

4



Reads og:image with og:image:width/height, host, title, description. Caches the unfurl by page URL — a copy change needs the Sharing Debugger to re-scrape; the ?v= on the image URL refreshes the picture.

X crawlable — robots fix shipped

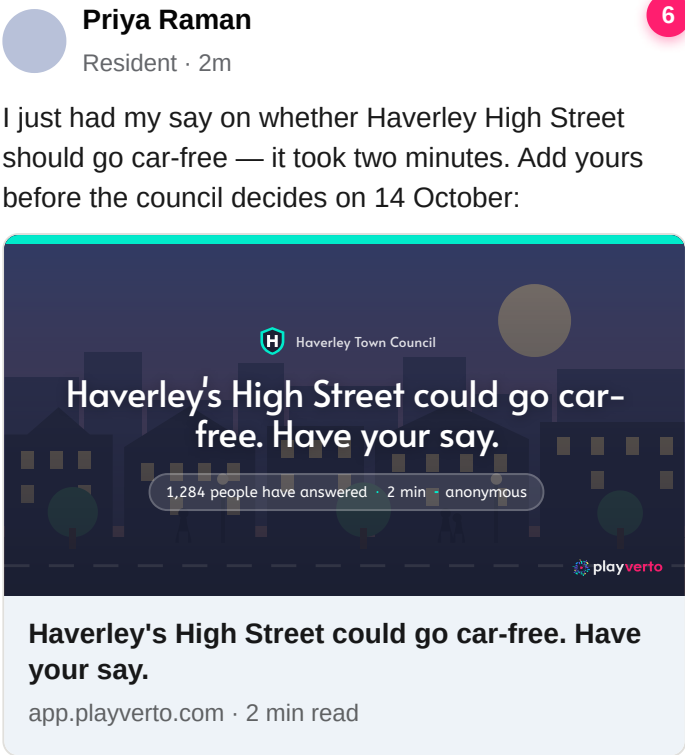
5



twitter:card=summary_large_image , image at 2:1 (15px shaved top and bottom), the title as an overlay pill — one line, ellipsised. No description.

LINKEDIN crawlable — robots fix shipped

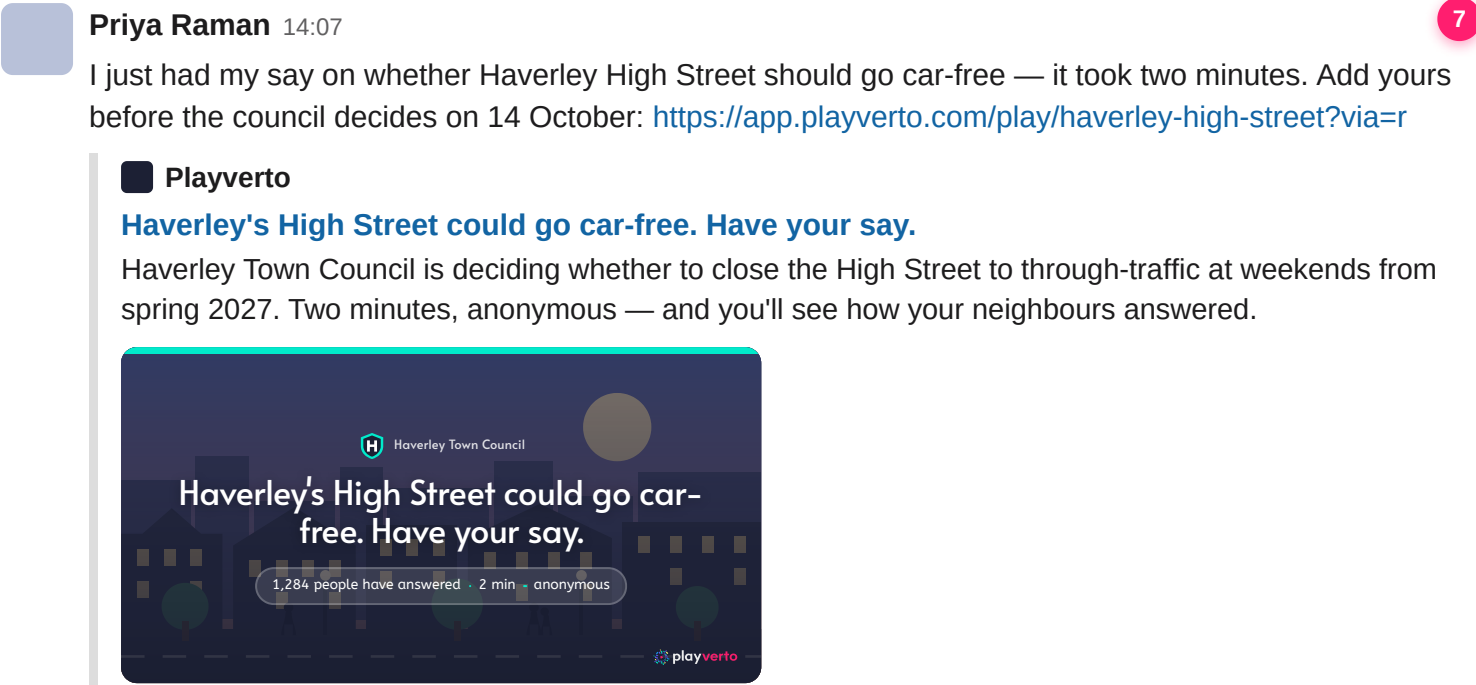
6



og:image at 1200×627 or 1.91:1, og:title ≤ 70 characters. No description on the card.

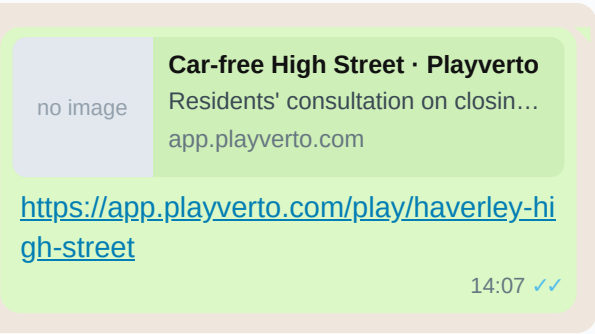
SLACK crawlable — robots fix shipped

7



og:site_name as the source line, title as the link, description, then the image. Slack, like X and LinkedIn, honours robots.txt — today it gets a bare URL from /play/.

WHAT THE LINK UNFURLS AS TODAY



For comparison: the internal theme as the title, the creator's editing brief as the description (show.html.erb:10-16), no image, no message, twitter:card=summary .

- 1

All seven read the same tag set. og:title is the headline everywhere; og:description shows on WhatsApp, Facebook and Slack but *not* on iMessage, X or LinkedIn — the headline has to stand alone. §2
- 2

One rule decides between the large preview and the small thumbnail on WhatsApp: a 1200×630 JPEG under 300 KB. The mockup card saves at ~120 KB at quality 82. §3
- 3

iMessage previews are built on the sender's phone and need an absolute https image URL; the page's <title> is ignored in favour of og:title.
- 4

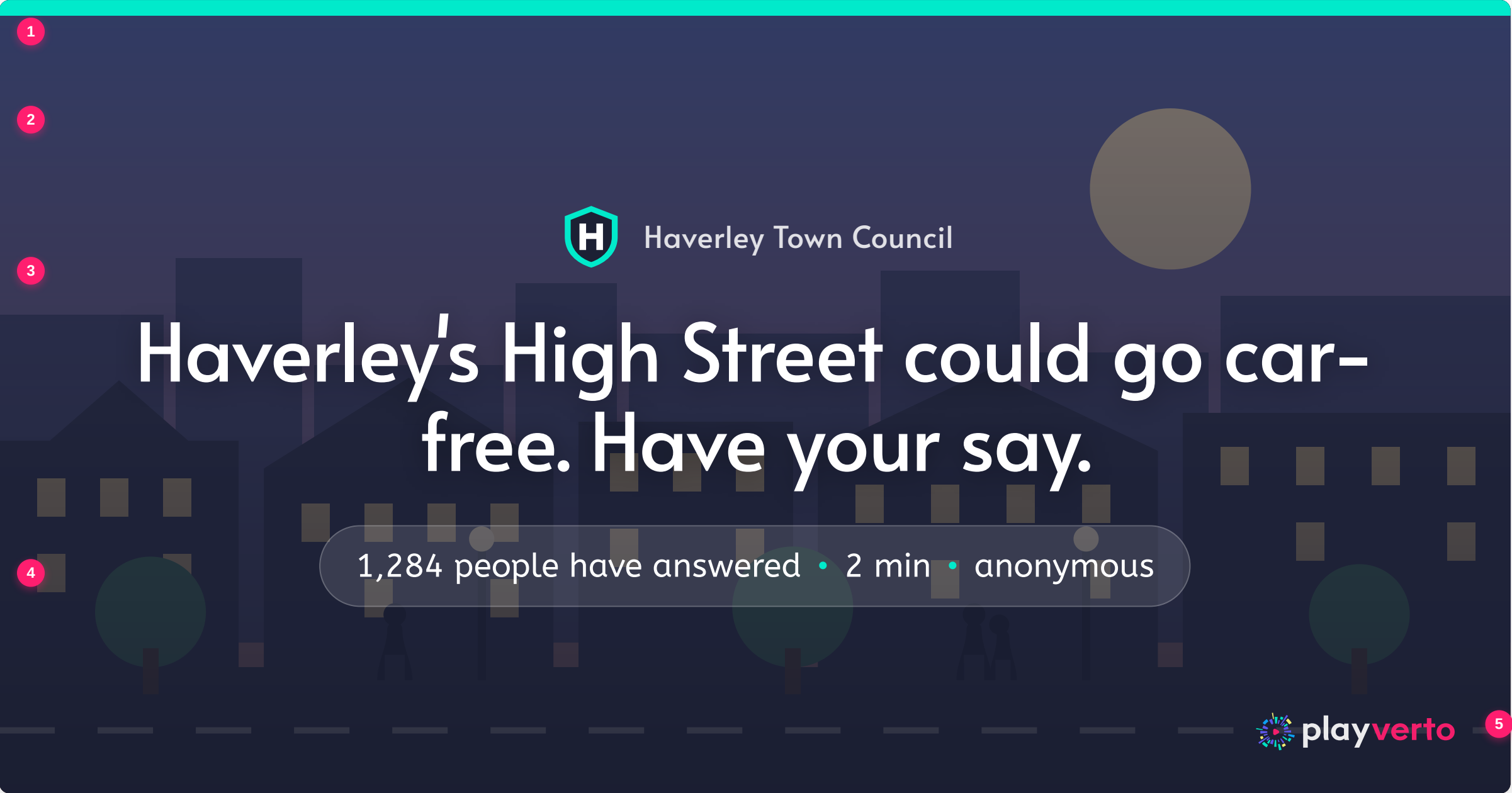
Facebook's crawler is documented as honouring robots.txt, and X, LinkedIn and Slack's do — so Disallow: /play/ used to leave the four right-hand tiles with nothing. **That line is now removed**, so all seven can fetch the page; what they render still waits on the og: tags in §2. §4
- 5

X trims the 1200×630 to 2:1 and overlays the title, so nothing important sits in the bottom 40px of the image.
- 6

LinkedIn caps og:title at 70 characters — the counter in the editor (E) enforces the tightest platform, not the loosest.
- 7

Slack shows everything, image last. Verify each with the Sharing Debugger, Card Validator and Post Inspector after the robots change ships.

DEFAULT: THE VERTO'S OWN BACKGROUND IMAGE UNDER A NAVY SCRIM



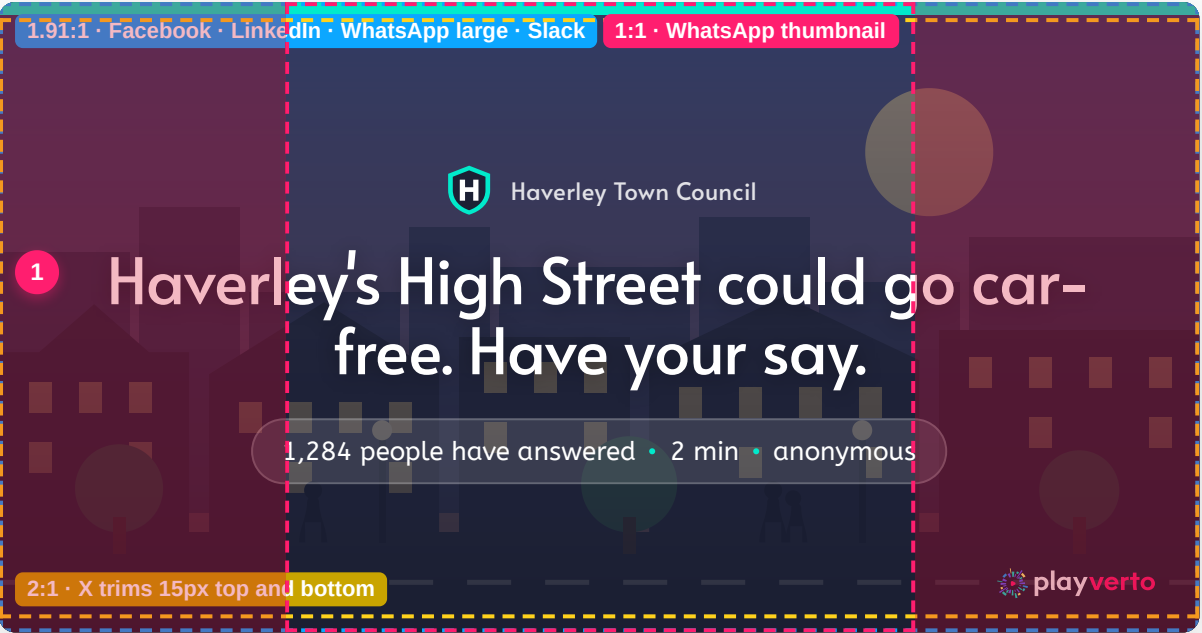
NOTES

- 1 The picture is the Verto's own `background_image` – a Pexels landscape or a library backdrop, never blank (`docs/how-vertos-get-their-imagery.md`) – under a 65% navy scrim. The change.org pattern: the petition photo. The street here is an illustrative stand-in.
- 2 A 12px aqua bar and the org's logo (white variant) with its name. Brand palette per Verto via `BrandPalette.resolve` , the same values the player uses.

3 The headline in Alata 64px, up to three lines; four lines auto-shrink to 56px. It is the only text that needs to survive every crop (D2).
- 4 The pill carries the live count (only once ≥ 50 responses; below that it reads "2 minutes · anonymous"), so the picture says the two things a friend wants to know before tapping.

5 The wordmark, bottom-right, as on the results share card (`infographic.html.erb`). Expendable under the square crop.
- § Rendered server-side from an SVG template through **ruby-vips** – libvips is already in the Dockerfile; `wkhtmltoimage` is not an option (`generates_results_report.rb:146`). Cached per `survey.updated_at` , so it renders once per edit, not once per share. Served at `/play/:token/share.jpg` . §3

CROP GUIDES ON THE DEFAULT IMAGE



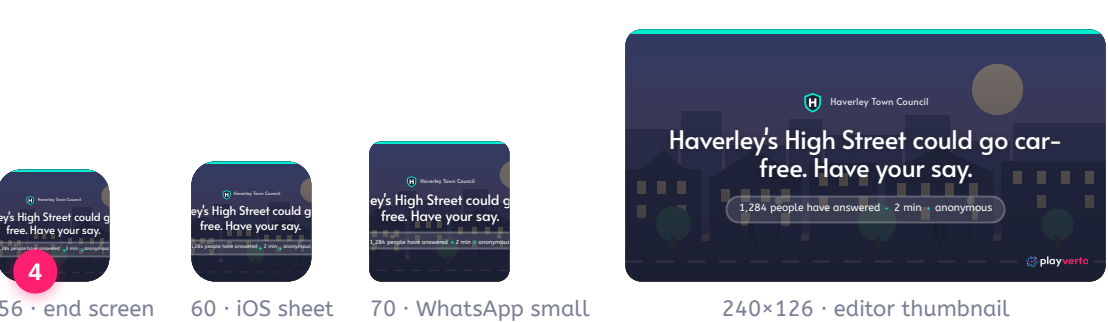
NO BACKGROUND IMAGE: BRAND GRADIENT FALLBACK



CREATOR UPLOAD: A TEXT-FREE PHOTO, 1200×630



WHAT THE THUMBNAIL CONTEXTS GET



NOTES

- 1 Facebook, LinkedIn, Slack and WhatsApp's large preview show the whole 1.91:1. X shaves 15px top and bottom for 2:1. WhatsApp's small thumbnail takes the centre 630×630 square (shaded margins are lost). So the logo and headline live in the middle band; only the wordmark is expendable.
- 2 A Verto with no background image (possible only for a hand-built deck) gets the brand gradient, --brand-panel to navy – the same layout, nothing missing.
- 3 Custom mode: the creator's own 1200×630 photo, moderated like every other upload (ImageModerator), resized with `resize_to_fill`. Every platform renders the headline as text beside the picture, so an upload should carry no words. §3
- 4 The square crops are where the picture stops being legible – which is why there is no separate 1:1 file: WhatsApp reads only the first og:image, and a 70px square says nothing whatever it contains. One crop-safe 1200×630 covers all of them.

NEW "SHARE PREVIEW" BLOCK, AFTER "AFTER THEY FINISH"

PUBLISH & SHARE

Preview, publish and distribute this Verto.

Status

After they finish

1Share preview

What a respondent's friends see when the link is passed on – in WhatsApp, Messages, Facebook, X, LinkedIn and Slack.

SHARE HEADLINE

56 / 70

2

Haverley's High Street could go car-free. Have your say.

SHARE STORY

186 / 200

Haverley Town Council is deciding whether to close the High Street to through-traffic at weekends from spring 2027. Two minutes, anonymous – and you'll see how your neighbours answered.

MESSAGE RESPONDENTS SEND

143 / 160

I just had my say on whether Haverley High Street should go car-free – it took two minutes. Add yours before the council decides on 14 October:

Written as the respondent. The link is added automatically.

3

✦ Suggest all three

IMAGE

4

☒ Auto – from this Verto's picture and headline

☐ Upload a 1200×630 photo

H

Haverley Town Council

Haverley's High Street could go car-free. Have your say.

1,284 people have answered · 2 min · anonymous

play

verto

Re-made whenever the headline, picture or palette changes.

LIVE PREVIEW

WhatsApp

5

H

Haverley Town Council

Haverley's High Street could go car-free. Have your say.

1,284 people have answered · 2 min · anonymous

play

verto

Haverley's High Street could go car-free. Have your say.

Haverley Town Council is deciding whether to close the High Street to through-traffic at weekends...
app.playverto.com

I just had my say on whether Haverley High Street should go car-free – it took two minutes. Add yours before the council decides on 14 October: app.playverto.com/play/haverley-high-street

Saved automatically. Editable after publishing – a change reaches new shares within the hour.

Languages

NOTES

1

A new accordion block in the Publish & share panel, after "After they finish" (`surveys/show.html.erb:1444`). Same inline-styled dark panel; not internationalised, like its neighbours. [§8](#)

2

Three fields with live counters set at the tightest platform limit (LinkedIn's 70 for the headline, 200 for the story, 160 for the message so it survives SMS). Saved via `survey_settings_path` like `share_enabled` . [§1](#)

3

✦ **Suggest** drafts all three from the theme, description, cards and organisation name – a tool-use call in the pattern of the other generators. Each field keeps an undo of what it replaced. AI-created Vertos arrive pre-filled by `SurveyGenerator` .

4

Image: Auto (the generated card, D1) or Upload (D2-3). The thumbnail is the actual `share.jpg` , not a mock.

5

The live preview in WhatsApp's shape updates as you type; the picture re-renders on save. An edit bumps `updated_at` , which rolls both the play-page cache and the image cache.

Per-link (`SurveyLink`) overrides and per-language share copy are deliberately not here in v1: the thank-you copy isn't translated today either, so every unfurl carries the default-locale text.

Playverto · Pass it on · respondent share mockups

10 / 12

RESPONSES

1,284

86% completed · 22 days live

PASSED ON BY RESPONDENTS

38

3% of responses arrived through a respondent's share link

1

NOTES

- 1 Counts responses whose `share_source` is "respondent" — set once, when the run started from a `?via=r` link. Completed responses, not taps: a tap is a vanity number. §5
- 2 The share URL carries `?via=r`; the player strips it on load and sends it with the submission, so the cached page is untouched.
- 3 v2, not drawn: per-sharer codes (`?via=r.k3f9`) would make "4 people answered after you shared" possible on the thank-you screen itself — the change.org loop.

§ What the boards imply — the spec for whoever builds it

Numbered to match the §n references in the notes. Everything here is still to build *except §4*, which has shipped — the rest is what the mockups commit to.

- 1

Three share fields and an image mode on the Verto

`share_title` (≤ 70), `share_description` (≤ 200), `share_message` (≤ 160), `share_image_mode` `auto` | `custom`, `has_one_attached` :`share_image` . Readers with fallbacks so a blank field gives today's behaviour: `share_title_text` $\rightarrow$ "theme · Playverto", `share_description_text` $\rightarrow$ `description` || `theme`, `share_message_text` $\rightarrow$ a default line from the locale files.
- 3

One generated JPEG, cached per edit

An SVG template (headline wrapped, org logo as a data URI, palette from `BrandPalette.resolve` , background photo fetched and composited) rendered by ruby-vips: `svgload_buffer` $\rightarrow$ `jpegsave_buffer(Q: 82, strip: true)` , stepping quality down until ≤ 300 KB. TTF Alata/ABeeZee installed in the Dockerfile for fontconfig. Body from `Rails.cache.fetch(["share-card", survey.id, survey.updated_at, org.updated_at])` , `Cache-Control`: `public, max-age=3600` . Custom mode serves the upload as a 1200×630 variant. A `defined?(Vips)` guard falls back to a static JPEG in dev and CI.
- 5

Attribution without touching the cache

Share URL = `play_survey_url(public_link_key) + "?via=r"` . The player reads `via` on load, keeps it in `sessionStorage`, strips it with `history.replaceState` , and adds `share_source`: "respondent" to the submit payload (`player_controller.js:1221`). The server whitelists it into a new indexed `responses.share_source` . `og:url` and `canonical` never carry the param. Per-sharer codes are v2.
- 7

"Include my answer", opt-in

Only when `show_comparison` is on. Headline card = `share_headline_card_index` or the first yes/no card; the label from the respondent's own answers, the percentage from the results JSON the compare panel already fetches. Toggle default off.
- 9

Strings

New `player.share_*` keys in all 26 locale files (heading, CTA, sheet title, message label, default message, with-answer message, include-my-answer, WhatsApp, Messages, Copy link, Copy message, More..., Copied, Email, QR hint, answered-count with plural forms), plus the `player` slice in `_i18n_js.html.erb` for anything JS renders; `bin/rails i18n:en_us` regenerates en-US. Editor strings stay English, as the panel does.

- 2

The tag set on `/play/:token` and `/test/:token`

`og:type`, `og:site_name`, `og:locale`, `og:url` (canonical, no query) + `rel=canonical`, `og:title`, `og:description`, `og:image` (absolute, `/play/:token/share.jpg?v=updated_at`), `og:image:secure_url` / `type` / `width 1200` / `height 630` / `alt`, `twitter:card=summary_large_image` , `twitter:image` + `alt`. Same owner-preview guard as today (`show.html.erb:8`). The page `<title>` stays as it is.
- 4

robots.txt no longer blocks `/play/` · shipped

`Disallow: /play/` is gone from `public/robots.txt` (`/test/`, `/invites/`, `/funder_invites/`, `/blazer` stay); the `X-Robots-Tag: noindex, nofollow` header stays as the binding half. Two reasons it was the wrong tool: bots that honour robots.txt can't unfurl what they may not fetch; and a crawler that may not fetch a page never receives the `noindex` either, so a linked `/play/` URL could still surface as a bare result. `search_indexing_test.rb` now asserts the absence, so re-adding the line fails a test.

`/test/` is still disallowed

– Test Mode links are shareable too, so that is the next line to consider.
- 6

The share payload and every fallback

`navigator.share({title: share_title_text, text: share_message, url})` via new data attributes on the player root; never `files:` . The sheet is server-rendered into the cached page (per-Verto content only): `wa.me/?text=` , `sms:?&body=` / `sms:?body=` , `mailto:` , X intent, Facebook sharer, LinkedIn share-offsite, clipboard for Copy link / Copy message, More... $\rightarrow$ `navigator.share` hidden when absent, QR via `verto_qr_svg` .
- 8

Editor block and Suggest

A `details.publish-block` after line 1470 of `surveys/show.html.erb` ; fields POST to `survey_settings_path` ; upload reuses the media-picker path and moderation; `POST /surveys/:id/share_suggest` $\rightarrow$ a small tool-use suggester; `SurveyGenerator` pre-fills the three fields for AI-created Vertos; a `share-preview` Stimulus controller drives the live preview.
- 10

Tests to add or move

Smoke test: the tag set, the fallbacks, a hostile `share_title` escaped. Test-mode: `og:image` on `/test/`. Search-indexing: the robots change. New: share image (JPEG, 1200×630, ≤ 300 KB, cache key rolls on `updated_at`, custom mode), share attribution (whitelisted, set once, ignored otherwise), model caps.

PLATFORM	READS	SHOWS DESCRIPTION	IMAGE RULE	PREVIEW FETCHED BY	WAS BLOCKED BY ROBOTS.TXT
WhatsApp	<code>og:title</code> , <code>og:description</code> , <code>og:image</code>	Yes	≤ 300 KB, $\geq 300\times 200$ for the large preview; else a 70px square	Sender's phone	Never was
iMessage / Messages	<code>og:title</code> , <code>og:image</code> , <code>og:site_name</code>	No	Absolute https URL; keep it small	Sender's phone	Never was
Android Messages (RCS)	<code>og:title</code> , <code>og:image</code>	Varies	As WhatsApp	Sender's phone	Never was
Facebook, Messenger	<code>og:*</code> incl. image width/height	Yes	1200×630 (min 600×315), 1.91:1	facebookexternalhit	Fixed — line removed
X	<code>twitter:card</code> , <code>twitter:image</code> $\rightarrow$ <code>og:image</code>	No	2:1, under 5 MB	Twitterbot	Fixed — line removed
LinkedIn	<code>og:title</code> ≤ 70 , <code>og:image</code>	No	1200×627	LinkedInBot	Fixed — line removed
Slack	<code>og:*</code>	Yes	Any; shown last	Slackbot–LinkExpanding	Fixed — line removed

Left out, and why

- A separate square image. WhatsApp reads only the first `og:image`, and at 70px nothing is legible anyway; one crop-safe 1200×630 covers every platform.
- `files:` in `navigator.share`. An attached image suppresses the link preview and turns the iOS sheet into photo-sharing. A "Save image" for Instagram Stories can come later, as its own control.
- Share-tap analytics. Only a completed response is worth a column (§5). Taps are vanity.
- Per-link and per-language share copy. The `nil-means-inherit` pattern on `SurveyLink` exists, but the thank-you copy isn't translated today either; v1 carries the default-locale text everywhere.
- An Android share-sheet board. Same semantics as A3, nothing new to say.
- Email as a phone tile. Behind More...; it comes forward on desktop (B2).